

mats. Over time, new media formats may be added to the required or optional format sets. At all times, the required set shall only include formats that are open standards.

The required and optional formats model brings the benefit of continued innovation in media codec technologies to the digital home while ensuring interoperability. DHR and DHS device vendors can differentiate their products by including support for one or more of the optional media formats while maintaining interoperability with all DHR devices by adhering strictly to the requirement to transcode to one of the required, open standard formats.

Alternatively, a DHS device may transcode from any format to one of the optional formats understood by a DHR device. This allows vendors to take advantage of better audio and video quality and, when possible, make more efficient use of available media storage and network bandwidth resources without sacrificing interoperability with devices that only implement the required format set. Digital home devices that source or render media content across the home network must also support a small set of baseline media streaming transports such as HTTP. The transfer scenarios that can be supported include:

- m A transfer from a DHS device to a DHR device, even if there is no actual immediate rendering of the media content. This may occur for an intelligent DHS device that distributes or replicates media content on the home network.
- m A transfer from a DHS device to an intelligent DHS device. Note that the intelligent DHS device would logically be acting as a DHR device in this scenario even if there is no immediate rendering of the media content. This may occur for an intelligent DHS device that aggregates, organises, processes, and/or archives media content on the home network.

Media management, distribution, and control

Media management and control enables devices and applications to identify, manage, and distribute media content across the stationary home network, or to transfer it to mobile devices. UPnP Audio/Video (AV) technology addresses all of these needs for the home network and is the media management and control solution for digital home